

ASHFORD FINANCIAL GROUP

Corporate Technology Procurement

REVISED ISSUE – SUPERSEDES RFP-AFG-2026-0064

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL

IT Service Management (ITSM) Platform, Managed Helpdesk & Major Incident Response Services

A technology and managed services modernization initiative

RFP Number	RFP-AFG-2026-0064-R1
Issue Date	May 11, 2026
Proposal Submission Deadline	June 22, 2026, 2:00 PM EST
Issuing Organization	Ashford Financial Group (AFG)
Category	Corporate IT Services — ITSM Platform, Helpdesk Outsourcing & Major Incident Response
Estimated Contract Value	See Section 13 — Commercial Terms

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1. Introduction & Background

Ashford Financial Group (“AFG” or “the Company”) is a regional bank holding company operating 55 branch locations across six states (Pennsylvania, Ohio, New York, New Jersey, Delaware, and Maryland), with approximately 2,650 employees, following the February 2026 acquisition of Colonial Trust Bank, which added 9 branch locations in Maryland. AFG’s current IT ticketing platform, TrackIT Legacy, was deployed in 2014 and no longer meets the Company’s needs for workflow automation, self-service, and reporting.

AFG is reissuing this Request for Proposal (RFP) to solicit qualified vendors to replace its legacy ticketing platform with a modern IT Service Management (ITSM) solution, provide outsourced Tier 1 and Tier 2 helpdesk support services, and establish a formal Major Incident Response capability, following a rise in Severity 1 outages observed across the combined AFG and Colonial Trust environment in the first quarter of 2026.

2. Definitions

Term	Definition
ITSM	IT Service Management — the platform and processes used to manage IT service requests, incidents, and changes.
Helpdesk	The vendor-operated support function that receives, triages, and resolves employee IT service requests.
SLA	Service Level Agreement — a contractually defined performance commitment.
TAM	Technical Account Manager — the vendor’s designated point of contact for service escalations.
FFIEC	Federal Financial Institutions Examination Council — issuer of interagency guidance applicable to bank technology vendors.
MSA	Master Services Agreement — the overarching contract governing the vendor relationship.

Note: This section is unchanged from the original RFP (RFP-AFG-2026-0064).

3. Project Objectives

- Replace the legacy TrackIT ticketing platform with a modern, ITIL v4-aligned ITSM solution.
- Establish outsourced Tier 1 and Tier 2 helpdesk support to improve first-contact resolution rates.
- Reduce average ticket resolution time by at least 25% within 12 months of go-live.
- Provide employees with a modern self-service portal and knowledge base.
- Maintain compliance with applicable FFIEC guidance on third-party technology service providers throughout the engagement.
- Reduce Major Incident (Severity 1) mean-time-to-resolution by at least 25% within 12 months of go-live. [NEW]

4. Scope of Work

1. Design, configure, and deploy a replacement ITSM platform covering incident, request, problem, and change management.
2. Provide outsourced Tier 1 and Tier 2 helpdesk support for approximately 2,650 AFG employees across 55 branch and corporate locations.

3. Migrate historical ticket data and the configuration management database (CMDB) from the legacy TrackIT platform and from Colonial Trust Bank's legacy ticketing system.
4. Deploy a self-service employee portal with a searchable knowledge base.
5. Integrate the ITSM platform with AFG's existing Azure Active Directory environment for authentication and asset ownership mapping.
6. Establish a formal Major Incident Management process, including defined roles, escalation paths, and post-incident review requirements. [NEW]
7. Provide administrator and power-user training for approximately 75 AFG IT staff.

5. Technical Requirements

5.1 ITSM Platform

- Alignment with ITIL v4 service management practices.
- Built-in configuration management database (CMDB) with automated asset discovery.
- Self-service portal accessible via web browser and a companion mobile app.
- Configurable workflow automation for common request types (password resets, access requests, hardware requests).
- Built-in Major Incident workflow templates, including automated stakeholder notification and status paging. [NEW]

5.2 Helpdesk Operations

- Tier 1 and Tier 2 helpdesk coverage 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, 365 days a year. [MODIFIED — was business hours only]
- Multichannel intake: phone, email, and self-service portal.
- First-contact resolution target of 70% or higher for Tier 1 tickets.

5.3 Hosting, Availability & Security

- Deployment model: cloud-hosted only. On-premise deployment will not be considered. [MODIFIED — REMOVES ON-PREM OPTION]
- System uptime service level agreement (SLA) of 99.9% or higher, measured monthly. [MODIFIED]
- Single sign-on (SSO) support via SAML 2.0, integrated with AFG's existing Azure Active Directory.
- Encryption at rest (AES-256 or equivalent) and in transit (TLS 1.2 or higher).
- Ticket and activity data retention of a minimum of 5 years. [MODIFIED]
- SOC 2 Type II certification required for the proposed hosting environment. [NEW]

5.4 System Integrations

- SSO integration with AFG's existing Azure Active Directory environment.
- Read-only data export capability to AFG's core banking platform (FIS) for asset-to-account correlation reporting.
- Integration with Colonial Trust Bank's legacy ticketing export files pending full data migration. [NEW]

5.5 Vendor Support Responsibilities [REFORMATTED — PRESENTED AS A TABLE IN THIS REVISION]

The selected vendor's ongoing support obligations shall include the following, with associated target service levels:

Responsibility	Description	Target SLA
Tier 1 Helpdesk Coverage	24/7/365 support for password resets, account lockouts, and basic troubleshooting	Answer within 60 seconds; resolve within 15 minutes
Technical Account Manager	Named TAM as single point of contact for service escalations	Response within 4 business hours
Monthly Service Reporting	Ticket volume, resolution time, and SLA compliance reporting	Delivered by the 5th business day of each month
Self-Service Knowledge Base	Maintained repository of self-service articles	Minimum 300 articles, updated monthly

Responsibility	Description	Target SLA
On-Site Support Coverage	On-site technician presence at AFG headquarters and the five highest-headcount branch locations	Business hours, Monday – Friday
Major Incident Response [NEW]	Dedicated Major Incident Commander engaged for Severity 1 outages	Engaged within 15 minutes of Sev-1 declaration

Note: Rows 1–5 restate the equivalent bullet-point content from the original RFP, updated to a tabular format with explicit SLA targets added. Row 6 (Major Incident Response) is a new addition.

6. [Reserved]

This section (previously “Vendor Onboarding & Staffing Requirements” in RFP-AFG-2026-0064) has been removed from this revision. Vendor personnel screening, security training, staffing roster notification, physical access control, and subcontracting approval requirements are now governed exclusively by the Master Services Agreement (MSA) executed at contract award. Vendors should not include responses to this section in their proposal.

7. Functional Requirements Matrix

Vendors must indicate compliance with each functional requirement in their proposal response using the codes: F (Fully Compliant), P (Partially Compliant — explain), C (Customization Required), N (Not Supported).

ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-01	Self-service password reset with MFA verification	Mandatory
FR-02	Automated ticket routing based on category and priority	Mandatory
FR-03	Configurable SLA timers with automated escalation	Mandatory
FR-04	CMDB with automated asset discovery	Mandatory
FR-05	Employee satisfaction survey after ticket closure	Desired
FR-06	Native mobile app for ticket submission and tracking	Desired
FR-07	Automated Major Incident stakeholder notification/paging	Mandatory
FR-08	Post-incident review (postmortem) workflow with action-item tracking	Mandatory

8. Eligibility Criteria

To be eligible for consideration, vendors must meet all of the following minimum criteria:

- Minimum of 7 years of experience providing ITSM platforms and/or managed helpdesk services to financial institutions. [MODIFIED]
- Minimum annual revenue of \$12,000,000 (audited financials for the most recent fiscal year required). [MODIFIED]
- At least 4 reference implementations for organizations with 1,500 or more employees, completed within the past 5 years.
- Vendor must demonstrate prior experience operating a formal Major Incident Management process for a financial services client. [NEW]
- Minimum insurance coverage: \$3,000,000 general liability; \$2,000,000 professional liability/E&O; \$2,000,000 cyber liability.

9. Deliverables

#	Deliverable	Due
1	Project Charter & Implementation Plan	30 days after contract award
2	ITSM Platform System Design Document	60 days after contract award
3	CMDB & Legacy Data Migration Completion Report (incl. Colonial Trust)	Prior to go-live
4	Self-Service Portal & Knowledge Base Launch	Per go-live milestone
5	Helpdesk Transition & Ramp-Up Plan	45 days after contract award
6	Major Incident Management Runbook [NEW]	Prior to go-live
7	SOC 2 Type II Attestation Report [NEW]	Prior to go-live
8	Training Materials & Delivered Sessions (75 IT staff)	Prior to go-live
9	Final Documentation Package	Project close-out

10. Project Timeline

Milestone	Date
RFP Reissue Date	May 11, 2026
Vendor Q&A Deadline	May 25, 2026
Proposal Submission Deadline	June 22, 2026
Shortlist Notification	July 6, 2026
Vendor Presentations	July 13 – 17, 2026
Contract Award	July 31, 2026
Project Kickoff	August 17, 2026

Milestone	Date
Helpdesk Transition Complete	November 2026
Major Incident Process Go-Live [NEW]	December 2026
ITSM Platform Go-Live	January 2027
Full Project Completion	March 2027

11. Evaluation Criteria

Proposals will be scored on a 100-point scale as follows:

Criterion	Weight
Technical Solution & Architecture	25 points
Vendor Experience & References	15 points
Implementation Timeline	10 points
Cost	25 points
Support & Maintenance Plan	10 points
Major Incident Readiness [NEW]	15 points

12. Insurance Requirements

- Commercial General Liability: \$3,000,000 per occurrence.
- Professional Liability / Errors & Omissions: \$2,000,000 per claim.
- Cyber Liability: \$2,000,000 per occurrence, covering data breach and business interruption.
- AFG and its officers, agents, and employees must be named as additional insureds on all policies except professional liability.

Note: This section is unchanged from the original RFP (RFP-AFG-2026-0064).

13. Commercial Terms

Estimated Project Budget: \$3,600,000 – \$4,700,000

Contract Term: 36 months, with two (2) optional 12-month renewals.

Payment Schedule

- 15% upon contract signing
- 25% upon helpdesk transition completion
- 20% upon Major Incident process go-live [NEW]
- 25% upon ITSM platform go-live
- 15% upon final acceptance

Other Commercial Terms

- Warranty period: 24 months following go-live, covering defect remediation at no additional cost. [MODIFIED]
- Payment terms: Net 30 from invoice date. [MODIFIED]
- Liquidated damages: 0.5% of total contract value per week of delay against the approved schedule, capped at 10% of total contract value. [NEW]

13.3 Service Level Credit Schedule [NEW — NO EQUIVALENT CONTENT IN ORIGINAL RFP]

The following service level credits apply once the contract is operational, in addition to any liquidated damages applicable during implementation:

SLA Metric	Threshold	Credit if Missed
Ticket first-response time	60 seconds	2% of monthly service fee
Severity 1 resolution time	4 hours	5% of monthly service fee
Platform uptime	99.9%	3% of monthly service fee per 0.1% below threshold, capped at 15%

14. Submission Instructions

Proposals must be submitted electronically in PDF format to proposals@ashfordfg.com no later than the deadline listed above. Proposals must remain valid for 150 days from the submission deadline. A sealed hard copy is not required. Late submissions will not be considered.

15. Terms & Conditions

15.1 Governing Law

This RFP and any resulting contract shall be governed by the laws of the Commonwealth of Pennsylvania.

15.2 Confidentiality

All proposal materials submitted become the property of AFG and will be treated as confidential business information, subject to standard non-disclosure obligations between the parties.

15.3 Reservation of Rights

AFG reserves the right to reject any or all proposals, waive minor irregularities, and negotiate final contract terms with the selected vendor.

15.4 Intellectual Property

All custom configurations, integrations, and documentation developed specifically for AFG under this engagement shall become the property of AFG upon final payment. Vendor retains ownership of pre-existing, generally licensed software.

Note: Sections 15.1–15.4 are unchanged from the original RFP (RFP-AFG-2026-0064).

15.5 Major Incident Reporting Obligation [NEW]

Vendor must notify AFG's Chief Information Security Officer within 30 minutes of declaring any Severity 1 Major Incident, and must deliver a written post-incident review report within 5 business days of incident resolution.

16. Contact Information

Issuing Officer	Renee Castillo
Title	Senior IT Procurement Manager
Email	rcastillo@ashfordfg.com
Phone	(717) 555-0188

Appendix A: Pricing Form

Vendors must complete the following pricing form in full. Unit prices must be all-inclusive of labor, materials, travel, and overhead unless otherwise noted.

Line Item	Description	Price
A-1	ITSM Platform Licensing (2,650 users)	\$_____
A-2	ITSM Implementation & Configuration Services	\$_____
A-3	Managed Helpdesk Services (Annual, Tier 1 & 2, 24/7/365)	\$_____
A-4	Legacy Data & CMDB Migration Services (incl. Colonial Trust)	\$_____
A-5	Self-Service Portal & Knowledge Base Setup	\$_____
A-6	Major Incident Management Program Setup [NEW]	\$_____
A-7	SOC 2 Type II Audit & Attestation Costs [NEW]	\$_____
A-8	Training (75 IT Staff)	\$_____
A-9	Total Proposed Price	\$_____

Appendix B: Reference Form

Provide at least 4 references meeting the eligibility criteria in Section 8. Duplicate this table as needed.

Field	Response
Client Organization	
Contact Name & Title	
Phone / Email	
Project Scope Summary	
Employees Supported	
Contract Value	
Completion Date	

Note: This appendix is unchanged from the original RFP (RFP-AFG-2026-0064).

Appendix C: Compliance Certification Checklist

Requirement	Certified (Y/N)
Vendor meets minimum 7 years relevant experience	
Vendor meets minimum annual revenue threshold	
Vendor holds required insurance coverage	
Vendor's proposed platform supports SSO via SAML 2.0	

Requirement	Certified (Y/N)
Vendor's helpdesk model meets 24/7/365 coverage requirement	
Vendor's hosting environment is SOC 2 Type II certified	
Vendor has submitted a Major Incident Management Runbook	